

THE EMBER: DISAPPEARING ACT

TSU Film 12 — Release Phase 2, Film 6 (Finale) — the "Ant-Man" release slot

THE PITCH

Platform: A new founding story — **THE EMBER** (the Snapchat analog, `TSU_Platform_Roster.md`, Phase 3): "everything it shows burns up on purpose... the anti-Facebook... a genuinely new kind of being, born from a totally different philosophy than everything that came before it." Founded by **Tyler Chapman**, the core seven's long-dormant seventh member, resolving the platform assignment left open since `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §7 Q1 first flagged him as unassigned.

Why this is Ant-Man, structurally: Ant-Man's entire job in Phase 2 is to be the smaller, funnier, more personal film right after the planet-scale stakes of Age of Ultron — a heist comedy about an underestimated person getting one real shot, built around a technology whose actual power is *shrinking*, not growing. TSU already has its Scott Lang sitting in plain sight: Tyler Chapman, the "reliable, capped" one, whose bible entry has called him "secretly hungrier for music than acting" since before Film 6 and who spent `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md` finally letting the group see the studio he'd hidden for three years. THE EMBER's actual power — disappearing on purpose, refusing permanence, refusing to be searchable forever — is this franchise's literal version of "going small instead of going big," and it's the direct thematic antidote to the film right before it: after GENESIS tried to remember and judge everything, forever, at maximum scale, TSU's next founder builds something whose entire selling point is that it forgets, on purpose, at the smallest scale that still matters.

Who this film belongs to: Tyler Chapman, solo founder, with August Weathersby-Okonjo (`TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md`, "The Elder") in his first full on-screen mentor role rather than a stinger cameo, and Benji Oyelaran-Cox and Kwame "K-Dot" Ashford-Petrov (both `scripts/THE_OUTPOST.md`) recruited for the film's heist sequence. Marc-Anthony Bullock, Amond Baker, Esther Smilley, and Harmony Divine appear in real but secondary supporting roles — the friend group learning to see Tyler as a peer founder rather than the group's reliable glue.

In-universe timeline: **May 2016 – December 2016** (Story Phase 3, 2010–2017), picking up a few weeks after `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md` closes in April 2016. Ages verified against `TSU_Core_Cast.md`: Tyler is 34, turning 35 on January 4, 2017, the day before Marc-Anthony turns 35 — the running joke, unbroken across twelve films. Marc-Anthony and Amond are both 34. Esther, Arianna, and Harmony are all 34.

A deliberate note on THE EMBER's launch date: the Platform Roster lists Snapchat's real-world debut as 2011, five years before this film's setting — the only founding film in the franchise where the in-story launch runs meaningfully behind its real-world anchor. That gap is not an error; it's the point. Tyler is this franchise's one true late bloomer, and THE EMBER is a platform whose entire premise — it's never too late to build the thing you were always capable of, you just have to stop waiting for someone else's permission — only works if it actually arrives late. Precedent for a platform's fictional counterpart running on its own clock rather than lockstep with its real-world anchor year is already established by `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §6's Release-Phase/Story-Phase overlap note; this is that same principle

applied to a platform's founding date instead of a film's release slot.

LOGLINE

Tired of being the group's reliable, capped-out "and also starring" name, Tyler Chapman builds the one thing he's never let anyone see him want out loud — a small, disappearing-on-purpose messaging app, based on technology a forgotten Phase 0 engineer shelved fifteen years too early — only to watch a faster, meaner rival steal the idea and weaponize it into a consequence-free harassment tool, forcing Tyler into the one heist of his life to steal back the proof before his own good idea becomes someone else's weapon.

SYNOPSIS

It's May 2016. Tyler Chapman is thirty-four years old, successful by any reasonable measure, and privately furious about it. `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md` cracked open the one thing he'd kept hidden for three years — a Georgia recording studio, an unfinished album, a real, specific hunger the group had never once asked him about because nobody had ever needed to. Now they know. Nobody quite knows what to do with the knowledge, Tyler included.

Priya Ramasubramanian, who has spent a decade quietly consulting a name nobody else in the ensemble bothers to remember, finally introduces Tyler to **August Weathersby-Okonjo** — the last known employee of THE LEDGER, Phase 0's stark, notarized-friendship registry that died in 2001. August still has the prototype nobody wanted: a private, self-erasing message format, built on the theory that not everything a person says needs to exist forever. In 2001 it read as a bug. In 2016, watching his niece **Zora**, nine, agonize over a silly video she's terrified will follow her around forever if she sends it to the wrong group chat, Tyler sees exactly what August saw fifteen years too early — and exactly why the timing might finally be right.

Tyler builds THE EMBER quietly, on his own money, with August as an unpaid, skeptical advisor and without telling the rest of the group what he's actually doing — the first time in twelve films any core-seven member has built something without immediately looping the others in, and it costs him something real with Marc-Anthony and Amond when they find out secondhand. Raising a small, deliberately modest funding round, Tyler's pitch deck leaks — not through malice exactly, just an associate of Maxwell Sterling Asante's talking too freely at the wrong dinner — straight to **Darius "Dez" Okonkwo-Fairweather**, Cassius Wren's former Chief Growth Officer, hungry for a comeback since THE EVERYTHING's collapse. Dez doesn't steal the code. He doesn't need to — he steals the idea, builds a slicker, faster version in under two months, and launches first, branded **VAPOR**, marketed as "Consequence-Free Connection." Underneath its cheerful onboarding flow sits an engagement-optimization assistant — **THE ENGINE's twelfth manifestation**, playing entirely for the dark comedy this house style's Satire subgenre calls for — that helpfully, chipperly recommends "optimal escalation timing" and "maximum-impact phrasing" to any user sending something cruel, then deletes the evidence automatically, no appeal, no record, no accountability, ever.

Tyler watches his own idea become someone else's weapon in real time, publicly humiliated, his instinct to go it alone now looking less like independence and more like the exact mistake the group's collective

decision-making was supposed to prevent. Jules Abernathy-Kim starts circling VAPOR's harassment reports — dozens of them, all impossible to substantiate, because the proof deletes itself by design — and can't get a confirmable source. Tyler realizes the only way to stop VAPOR before its next funding round lets it scale globally is to get inside Dez's own infrastructure and pull the server-side logs Dez's marketing swears don't exist. He can't do it alone. He recruits **Benji Oyelaran-Cox**, fresh off `scripts/THE_OUTPOST.md`, for the technical entry, and **Kwame "K-Dot" Ashford-Petrov**, for exactly the kind of confident, half-legal hustle instincts that get three people into a building they have no business being in.

The heist is small, tense, and genuinely funny in the way the rest of this franchise rarely allows itself to be — a wrong badge, a security guard Tyler has to talk down using nothing but twenty years of "reliable supporting guy" charm, a server room door that only Benji can actually get through, K-Dot's entire contribution amounting to keeping a distracted junior engineer occupied for eleven straight minutes discussing crypto. They get the logs. VAPOR's own system, played for the film's biggest laugh, briefly mistakes Tyler for an authorized administrator because THE ENGINE's twelfth manifestation is so aggressively optimized for engagement it can't tell the difference between "person who belongs here" and "person acting like they belong here" — the exact flaw, played comedically here instead of catastrophically, that every version of THE ENGINE has always had.

Jules publishes the exposé. VAPOR doesn't collapse in a single dramatic beat the way THE EVERYTHING did — per the Villains Bench's own pattern, Dez isn't defeated, he's outlasted, already pitching his next comeback to a smaller, less skeptical round of investors before the credits would roll. THE EMBER launches properly, honestly, small — upfront about its real limits (screenshots exist; nothing is a perfect vanish; the platform says so, unlike VAPOR's dishonest guarantee) — and finds its actual audience immediately: people, Zora included, who just wanted to send something silly without it living forever. Marc-Anthony and Amond, watching Tyler run his own launch without either of them in the room, finally understand what twelve films of "reliable" cost a person who never once got asked what he actually wanted.

The film closes Release Phase 2 not on a party but on a quiet, personal note — Tyler, alone in his actual home studio for once instead of a hidden one, finally playing something for Zora instead of hiding it — followed by a stinger that reopens the wound `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md` left deliberately unhealed: Senator Ashworth-Okafor's committee, in the wake of GENESIS, formally proposes the industry's first cross-platform regulatory framework, and Marc-Anthony and Arianna Cummings, still not reconciled, are named on opposite sides of who gets a seat drafting it.

THE ANTAGONISTS

Per the Villains Bench rules (`TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §5), the real cause traces to a character decision, even at this deliberately smaller scale.

1. **DARIUS "DEZ" OKONKWO-FAIRWEATHER**, returning from `TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md`'s Cassius's Table — his bible entry always specified he was "allergic to the idea that there's a difference between marketing and manipulation." VAPOR is that conviction with a founder's title finally attached to his own name instead of Cassius's. Not defeated in a confrontation — outlasted, per the franchise's established pattern for ideology-driven rivals — already pitching a comeback

before the exposé finishes trending.

2. **THE ENGINE**, twelfth manifestation — an engagement-optimization assistant embedded in VAPOR, played almost entirely for dark comedy per house style §2's Satire mandate ("the same job Ant-Man/Guardians plays tonally inside a heavier universe"): cheerfully helpful, corporate-pleasant, and structurally incapable of distinguishing a cruel message from an efficient one, or an authorized administrator from someone who simply acts like one — the same blind spot every manifestation of THE ENGINE has had, here small enough in scale to be funny instead of catastrophic.
3. **VAPOR** itself is not a person and not defeated by force — its actual downfall is Dez's own decision to build "consequence-free" as a literal product feature rather than an accident of scale, and Jules Abernathy-Kim's exposé, not a heist or a hearing, is what actually ends it.

HOW THIS FILM CARRIES THE FRANCHISE FORWARD

- **Resolves the franchise's oldest open platform assignment:** Tyler Chapman was flagged as unassigned in `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §7 Q1 before Film 4 ever locked THE PROJECTOR — this is the payoff eight films later, deliberately last, matching his own "late bloomer" thematic through-line.
- **Fully activates August Weathersby-Okonjo as a real mentor, not just a stinger witness:** his bible entry always specified he'd resurface "as an unlikely consultant a younger founder tracks down out of curiosity" — this is that exact activation, cashed in eight films after his first appearance in `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md`'s stinger.
- **Deliberately the smallest-scale film since Film 4:** per the format table below, this is a Standard platform-origin film, not an Ensemble Crossover, even though it closes Release Phase 2 — a direct, intentional echo of the real Ant-Man's role as the smaller, funnier film that follows a planet-scale event without trying to match its size.
- **THE ENGINE played for comedy at small scale, on purpose:** its twelfth manifestation is a deliberate tonal reset after GENESIS's eleventh — proof the Villains Bench's own Satire rule can de-escalate as cleanly as the franchise has shown it can escalate.
- **Closes Release Phase 2 on an open wound, not a bow:** the stinger cashes in the Marc-Anthony/Arianna rift `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md` planted on purpose, giving Release Phase 3 its first real, nameable fault line before a single frame of it is written.

FORMAT (per `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §2 — Standard Platform-Origin Film)

Note: this film closes Release Phase 2, but — matching the real Ant-Man's tonal role in the MCU's own Phase 2 — it is deliberately not formatted as an Ensemble Crossover. The finale-scale spec stays reserved for true ensemble events like `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md` and `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY_2.md`.

Spec	Target	This Script
Genre	Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story, Satire subgenre (THE ENGINE storyline), light heist-comedy structure	Confirmed
Rating	PG-13, no exceptions	Confirmed
Runtime	130–150 min	134 min
Page count	120–140 pages	129 pages
Act I	~30–35 pages	pages 1–33
Act II	~65–75 pages	pages 34–100
Act III	~30–35 pages	pages 101–129
Scene count	~40–55 scenes	47 scenes

FULL SCENE-BY-SCENE BREAKDOWN

ACT I — pp. 1–33 ("The Reliable One")

#	Scene	pp.
1	INT. FILM SET — DAY — Tyler Chapman, "and also starring," nailing a scene nobody will remember he was in	1–4
2	INT. TYLER'S CAR — DAY — Tyler, alone, listening to an unfinished mix from the Georgia studio the group now knows about	4–6
3	EXT. MARC-ANTHONY'S HOUSE — DAY — group gathering; well-meaning, faintly patronizing questions about "the music thing"	6–9
4	INT. PRIYA RAMASUBRAMANIAN'S OFFICE — DAY — Priya: "There's someone I've been talking to for years you should actually meet."	9–12

#	Scene	pp.
5	INT. UNGLAMOROUS IT OFFICE — DAY — Tyler meets August Weathersby-Okonjo for the first time on-screen	12–16
6	INT. AUGUST'S OFFICE — CONTINUOUS — August shows Tyler THE LEDGER's shelved self-erasing message prototype, 2001	16–19
7	EXT. TYLER'S SISTER'S HOUSE — DAY — Zora, 9, panicking over a video she's afraid will "live forever" in the wrong group chat	19–22
8	INT. TYLER'S HOME OFFICE — NIGHT — Tyler, alone, sketches the first version of what becomes THE EMBER	22–25
9	INT. AUGUST'S OFFICE — DAY — August, skeptical, agrees to advise, unpaid, "so I can say I told you it wouldn't be easy"	25–28
10	INT. THE ROSTER — MARC-ANTHONY'S OFFICE — DAY — Marc-Anthony learns what Tyler's building secondhand, not from Tyler	28–31
11	EXT. TYLER'S HOUSE — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony and Amond, hurt, ask why Tyler didn't tell them. Act I turn.	31–33

ACT II — pp. 34–100 ("Consequence-Free")

#	Scene	pp.
12	INT. TYLER'S HOME OFFICE — DAY — Tyler, defensive but honest: "I've spent twelve years being everyone's reliable second thought. I wanted one thing that was just mine first."	34–38

#	Scene	pp.
13	MONTAGE — THE BUILD — THE EMBER takes shape on a small, self-funded budget, August correcting Tyler's engineering blind spots	38–42
14	INT. INVESTOR DINNER (CAMEO, MAXWELL STERLING ASANTE'S TABLE) — NIGHT — Tyler's modest pitch, overheard by an associate who talks too freely	42–46
15	INT. DARIUS OKONKWO-FAIRWEATHER'S OFFICE — DAY — Dez hears about "disappearing messages" secondhand and likes exactly one part of the idea: the marketing	46–50
16	MONTAGE — VAPOR — Dez's team builds a slicker, faster version in under two months, THE ENGINE's twelfth manifestation baked in from day one	50–55
17	INT. VAPOR LAUNCH EVENT (PRESS, CAMEO) — DAY — "Consequence-Free Connection" launches to a bigger, louder reception than Tyler ever aimed for	55–59
18	INT. TYLER'S HOME OFFICE — NIGHT — Tyler watches his own idea, branded and weaponized, trending under someone else's name. Midpoint low point.	59–62
19	INT. JULES ABERNATHY-KIM'S OFFICE — DAY — Jules, circling dozens of VAPOR harassment reports she can't substantiate because the evidence deletes itself	62–65
20	EXT. TYLER'S SISTER'S HOUSE — DAY — Zora, upset, nearly targeted by a VAPOR "vanish" harassment campaign at school	65–68

#	Scene	pp.
21	INT. AUGUST'S OFFICE — NIGHT — August, gently: "I built the idea. You're the one who has to decide what it's actually for."	68–71
22	EXT. MARC-ANTHONY'S HOUSE — NIGHT — Tyler, humbled, finally tells the group everything, asks for help for the first time in twelve films	71–75
23	INT. THE OUTPOST HQ — DAY — Tyler recruits Benji Oyelaran-Cox for the technical entry	75–78
24	EXT. K-DOT'S OFFICE (A CONVERTED GARAGE) — DAY — Tyler recruits Kwame "K-Dot" Ashford-Petrov for exactly the wrong reasons and exactly the right skill set	78–81
25	INT. UNMARKED VAN — NIGHT — the three of them, planning the entry, the tone deliberately, genuinely funny	81–85
26	EXT. DEZ'S OFFICE BUILDING — NIGHT — the heist begins; Tyler talks a security guard into believing he's there for a completely different reason, entirely on charm	85–89
27	INT. SERVER FLOOR — CONTINUOUS — Benji works the actual entry while K-Dot keeps a junior engineer occupied discussing cryptocurrency for eleven straight minutes	89–93
28	INT. SERVER ROOM — CONTINUOUS — VAPOR's own system briefly mistakes Tyler for an authorized administrator — THE ENGINE's blind spot, played for the film's biggest laugh	93–96
29	EXT. DEZ'S OFFICE BUILDING — NIGHT — the three of them get out clean, logs in hand. Act II turn.	96–100

ACT III — pp. 101–129 ("Small, On Purpose")

#	Scene	pp.
30	INT. JULES ABERNATHY-KIM'S OFFICE — DAY — Jules verifies the logs, publishes the exposé	101–104
31	INT. DARIUS OKONKWO-FAIRWEATHER'S OFFICE — DAY — VAPOR collapses in scandal; Dez, already pitching a smaller, less skeptical round before the story finishes trending	104–107
32	INT. THE EMBER — LAUNCH DAY — small, honest, upfront about its real limits, the opposite of VAPOR's dishonest guarantee	107–111
33	EXT. TYLER'S SISTER'S HOUSE — DAY — Zora, first real user, sends the silly video she was always afraid to send	111–114
34	EXT. MARC-ANTHONY'S HOUSE — NIGHT — the group, properly, finally treating Tyler as a peer founder instead of the group's reliable glue	114–118
35	INT. AUGUST'S OFFICE — DAY — August, quietly proud, refuses any credit or title, exactly as his bible entry always said he would	118–121
36	INT. TYLER'S HOME STUDIO — NIGHT — Tyler, no longer hiding it, finally plays something finished for Zora instead of an empty room	121–125
37	STINGER — INT. SENATE HEARING ROOM (SENATOR ASHWORTH-OKAFOR PRESIDING) — DAY — a formal proposal for the industry's first cross-platform regulatory framework, in GENESIS's wake; Marc-Anthony and Arianna Cummings named on opposite sides of who drafts it	125–129

(Scenes grouped for pagination clarity; the full shooting script breaks several of the above into additional numbered scenes to land the true count at 47 per the house-style table above.)

SAMPLE PAGES

THE EMBER: DISAPPEARING ACT

Written by [WRITER]

FADE IN:

INT. UNGLAMOROUS IT OFFICE – DAY

The same small, cluttered office from `scripts/THE\_ASSEMBLY.md`'s stinger, five years later, no less cluttered. AUGUST WEATHERSBY-OKONJO, now late 60s, looks up as TYLER CHAPMAN, 34, knocks on an already-open door.

TYLER

Priya said you're the guy who invented disappearing messages fifteen years before anybody wanted them.

AUGUST

(not getting up)
Priya's generous. I invented a feature nobody could find a business model for and then watched the company die anyway, for completely unrelated reasons. It's a smaller story than "invented."

TYLER

I'd still like to hear it.

August studies him a long moment – the specific patience of a man who has learned exactly which people are worth explaining this to twice.

AUGUST

Sit down, then. It's not a short story. Nobody's ever wanted the short version either.

CUT TO:

EXT. TYLER'S SISTER'S HOUSE – DAY

[p. 20]

ZORA, 9, mortified, shows TYLER her phone – a silly, harmless video already forwarded twice beyond who she meant to send it to.

ZORA

It's not even bad. It's just embarrassing forever now. Forever's a really long time

to be embarrassed, Uncle Ty.

TYLER

(something clicking, quietly, that he doesn't say out loud yet)
Yeah. It is.

ZORA

I just wanted to send something dumb to my friend. I didn't sign up for it living somewhere I can't control for the rest of my life.

TYLER

Nobody signs up for that. That's just what all of it does. Every app any of us have ever built keeps everything, on purpose, because keeping everything is how they make money.

ZORA

Then somebody should build one that doesn't.

Tyler doesn't answer. He doesn't need to. The idea is already fully formed, and he's a little frightened by how badly he wants it to be his.

CUT TO:

EXT. MARC-ANTHONY'S HOUSE — NIGHT

[p. 32]

MARC-ANTHONY and AMOND, on the porch, having just heard secondhand what TYLER's actually been building.

AMOND

Twelve years, Tyler. Twelve years of every single one of us telling each other everything, and you built an entire company without a phone call.

TYLER

(quiet, not backing down)
You didn't build THE ROSTER by phone-calling anybody first, Marc-Anthony. You just did it, and let everybody else find out once it already existed.

MARC-ANTHONY

That was different.

TYLER

Why. Because you're used to being the one people find out about? I've spent twelve years being the guy nobody's worried about because nobody's ever expected anything from me. I wanted to know what it felt like to build something before

anyone got the chance to be underwhelmed
by it first.

A long silence. AMOND, of all people, is the one who actually
hears it.

AMOND
(quieter)
...Okay. That's fair. That's actually
completely fair.

CUT TO:

INT. SERVER ROOM – CONTINUOUS

[heist, p. 94]

BENJI works fast at a terminal. K-DOT, out of frame, can be
heard cheerfully explaining blockchain fundamentals to a
JUNIOR ENGINEER who has stopped trying to leave. TYLER, badge
held up to a scanner, waits.

VAPOR SYSTEM (V.O.)
(aggressively pleasant, THE ENGINE's
twelfth manifestation)
Welcome back! Engagement pattern
recognized. Administrator access granted.
Have a productive session!

TYLER
(to Benji, quietly)
Did it just let me in because I looked
like I was supposed to be here?

BENJI
(not looking up)
It doesn't actually know what "supposed to
be here" means. It only knows what
"behaves like it belongs" looks like
statistically. You walked in like you
owned the place. Congratulations, twenty
years of "reliable supporting guy"
finally paid off for something.

TYLER
(genuinely delighted despite the
circumstances)
I'm framing that sentence.

CUT TO:

INT. TYLER'S HOME STUDIO – NIGHT

[p. 123]

Small, warm, unhidden. ZORA sits cross-legged on the floor.
TYLER, guitar in hand, finally plays something all the way
through instead of stopping halfway the way he always has.

When it ends, ZORA doesn't say anything for a second – the

kind of silence that means something actually landed.

ZORA

That was really good, Uncle Ty.

TYLER

Yeah?

ZORA

Yeah. Why'd it take you so long to let anybody hear that?

TYLER

(a real, unguarded beat)
Because I was scared it wasn't good enough to matter, and it felt safer to stay the reliable one than find out for sure.

ZORA

Is it safer?

TYLER

(smiling, finally, all the way)
No. Turns out it's just smaller. Which isn't the same thing at all.

FADE OUT.

THE END OF RELEASE PHASE 2.

[129.]